

EMPOWERMENT

2023

BUILD IT SUPERNATURALLY

TEXT: Mark 16:15-20 (KJV) *“Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature. ¹⁶ He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved; but he that believeth not shall be damned. ¹⁷ And these signs shall follow them that believe; In my name shall they cast out devils; they shall speak with new tongues; ¹⁸ They shall take up serpents; and if they drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them; they shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover. ¹⁹ So then after the Lord had spoken unto them, he was received up into heaven, and sat on the right hand of God. ²⁰ And they went forth, and preached everywhere, the Lord working with them, and confirming the word with signs following. Amen.”*

INTRO: The setting for our text, is Mark describing the events surrounding the resurrection of Jesus.

Mark describes the actions and words of Jesus following this cemetery spectacular. He lets us know that Jesus met with the eleven Disciples as they were gathering for a meal function. Mark tells us that it is against this backdrop, that Jesus issues “*The great suggestion.*” --- I mean, “*The Great Commission.*”

All of us can agree that “*The Great Commission*” is the marching orders of the First Century Church, and those orders have continued through September 26, 2023.

I would like each of us to give ourselves a letter grade in our head on how we have scored on fulfilling “*The Great Commission.*” --- Do we get an A, B, C, D, or F?

I would also like to make it very clear that the fulfillment of “*The Great Commission*” is literally impossible to accomplish apart from a

Supernatural order of ministry. Acts 1:8 (KJV)
“You shall receive Power AFTER the Holy Ghost has come upon you...” Jesus affirms this in our text, *“And these signs shall follow them that believe; In my name shall they cast out devils; they shall speak with new tongues; ¹⁸ They shall take up serpents; and if they drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them; they shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover.*

So here is the question I want to pose tonight –
“What does it look like to build a church or ministry utilizing the supernatural?”

In my opinion there are at least three prerequisites for building a church or ministry that employs a Supernatural bent.

THE DESIGN MUST HAVE THE FINGERPRINTS OF GOD ON IT...

Allow me to ask you a question – *“Are you building what God placed in your heart, or are you building what someone at a conference told*

you to build?” If we are going to accomplish our purpose and build what the Lord has sent us to build, the Holy Ghost must be the architect!

(My experience when I first came to Houston in 2001 – Consultant told me I was going to have to put an end to the Gifts of the Spirit – Or do that in a different venue – My question to him – Have you ever had 3,000 people saved in one day? – And I fired him)

Where is He allowed to operate at your place?
He will not be where He is not welcome!

All architects have their names on their plans – If we are building something that the Holy Spirit has not signed off on, we are building the wrong thing. If we build what the Holy Spirit designs, it will outlive us!

A healthy church or ministry sees, seizes, and lives out the supernatural. At Community Transformation Church, we have had a summer of miracles! **(PLACE THE PICTURE OF THE MIRACLE WALL ON THE SCREEN)**

(Miracle and Healing services – You have to peddle this bicycle) **(TAKE MIRACLE WALL OFF THE SCREEN)**

Whatever you are going to build, build it Supernaturally:

- The incarnation of Jesus Christ was Supernatural...
- The miracles of Jesus were Supernatural...
- The resurrection of Jesus was Supernatural...
- The compilation of Scripture was Supernatural...
- The birth of the Church was Supernatural...
- The survival of the Church has been Supernatural...

The point of living the Supernatural, is to show others the authenticity of the life of Jesus Christ.

Pastor Mike Thomas preached here last Sunday morning and he said, *“A map will take you where others have gone, but a compass can take you where others have not gone.”* **(PLACE ON**

THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE) I want to challenge every Pastor, leader, and church member in here tonight, to set your “*Due North*” on living a Supernatural life and having a Supernatural order of ministry!

(PLACE A PIC OF THE HONEY BUZZARD ON THE SCREEN AND LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL YOU PUT UP THE FLIGHT MAP)

Recently, in South Africa, a female European Honey Buzzard was fitted with a satellite tracking system. She left South Africa to start heading north on April 20th, and on June 2nd, she finally reached Finland. She will spend the summer in Finland, before returning again next season for a visit to South Africa.

Here is an image showing the data received from the tracker which plots out the route that she took to head north. **(PLACE A PICTURE OF THE HONEY BUZZARD AND HER FLIGHT PATH ON THE SCREEN AND**

LEAVE IT ON THE SCREEN UNTIL I CHANGE POINTS)

In 42 days, this bird covered over 6,000 miles!
She averaged more than 150 miles per day for
42 days!

While maintaining her due north direction, she
made some temporary midcourse adjustments so
that she was never over just water, so that she
could land if need be. In more than 6,000 miles
of flying, this bird never allowed her midcourse
adjustments to affect her due north direction!

All of us have had to make some midcourse
adjustments, but we cannot allow those
moments to hijack the journey and force us into
a place that God never intended for us to be! We
must ***“Earnestly contend for the faith that was
delivered to the First Century Saints!”***

A healthy church or ministry sees, seizes, and
lives the Supernatural.

(TAKE DOWN MAP)

A SUPERNATURAL ORDER OF MINISTRY INVOLVES MIRACLES, SIGNS, AND WONDERS

The proof that we are who we say we are, and the proof that our message is true is miracles, signs, and wonders. *“These signs SHALL follow those who believe...”*

These three words, *“Miracles, Signs and Wonders”* are frequently found together in the New Testament in one order or another.

- 1) The Greek word translated as *“miracles”* is (δύναμις) dunamis, and it means *“a deed manifesting great power with the implication of some supernatural force.”* Oftentimes we find it translated in the New Testament as *“power, mighty works, and strength.”* The word dunamis has been described as *“Explosions of Almightyines.”*
- 2) The Greek word translated as *“sign”* is (σημεῖον) semeion, and it means *“a*

sign, a mark; by which a person or thing is distinguished from others and is known; an event which is regarded as having some special meaning; not simply a miraculous event but something which points to a reality of even greater significance.”

(HAVE SOMEONE TO PUT UP “I DID THIS – GOD” YARD SIGNS AROUND THE STAGE)

- 3) The Greek word translated as “*wonder*” is (τέρας) teras, and it means “*a marvel*.” It speaks to the wonder or awe that is produced in those who witness the miracle, or the dunamis.

Therefore:

- A miracle is the supernatural power of God being manifest in the natural realm...
- A sign points up the fact that no one but God could have done such a thing... **(HAVE EVERYONE TO STAND THAT HAS**

HAD AN UNMISTAKEABLE MIRACLE – DISTRIBUTE SIGNS)

- A wonder is the awe that is produced in the hearts of the people as they witness the miracle...

All three together, miracles, signs, and wonders give a complete revelation of the Supernatural power of God and are utilized in turning our hearts, and the hearts of others to God. (Over one million Muslims a month are turning to God – Most of them come to God as a result of a Miracle)

If we are to build a ministry that displays the Supernatural, we cannot build it apart from the person and work of the Holy Spirit!

A SUPERNATURAL ORDER OF MINISTRY MUST BE PASSED ON

There are two prevailing thoughts today in the Pentecostal/Charismatic world, when it comes to the things of The Spirit:

- The Holy Spirit has been shoved off the stage of many churches, and banned from the property in many others! He is treated like a crazy cousin at a family reunion. He receives this kind of treatment in churches and ministries that He Himself built!
- Among authentic Pentecostals, many want to recapture the past and try to reproduce the miraculous. We do not need to recapture a past experience, we need to allow Him to recapture us!!

He will show up, where He is permitted to do something authentic, even if it is a new thing! (My experience praying for God to show His power to the next generation – He said, *“Is it okay with you if it looks different in the next generation?”* Isaiah 43:19 (KJV) ***“Behold, I will do a new thing; now it shall spring forth; shall ye not know it? I will even make a way in the wilderness, and rivers in the desert.”***

Are we ready to be recaptured by a God that performs miracles, signs, and wonders? What price are we willing to pay to see Him do it?

If we are fortunate enough to partner with Holy Spirit to build something that has Supernatural characteristics, what is our plan to pass it to the next generation?

The calling card of the authentic is – Mark 16:17: *And these signs shall follow them that believe...*

- *“In my name shall they cast out devils...”*
Britt Brooks – The devil said, *“I know who you are!”* Pastor Britt said, *“Good, then you know you won’t be staying long!”*
- *“In my name... They shall speak with new tongues...”* A Supernatural Church will ALWAYS be a tongue talking Church – BUT not all tongue talking churches are Supernatural.
- *“In my name... They shall take up serpents...”* All power has been given to

Jesus! He has *“Given us power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy. And nothing shall by any means hurt us.”*

- *“In my name... If they drink any deadly thing, it shall not hurt them...”* Covid...
- *“In my name they shall lay hands on the sick, and they shall recover.”* Summer of miracles. **(PLACE PICTURE OF MIRACLE WALL ON THE SCREEN AND LEAVE IT UP UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

CONCLUSION:

If God is transgenerational, and eternal - He may not be interested in partnering with a church or ministry that is only focused on building something that will last for a single generation!

- Who are you bringing with you?
- Who are you discipling?
- Who are you pouring into?

- Who are you parenting or reparenting?
Susan's purpose statement is that she is *"Reparenting a generation for Legacy's sake."* My purpose statement is, *"I innovate so others can have a greater generational impact."* (Have our spiritual children to stand) If the devil thinks he can kill us and end our work in this earth – His plan will fail, because these people bear our spiritual DNA, and they will begin where we end – What we start or finish is not nearly as important as who we start!

If you die in the next twelve months will your work in the earth cease? If so, you are not building in a Supernatural way!

If we are partnering with God in a Supernatural effort, we will be focused on passing the mantle to the next generation. The people we hand the generational baton to must be taught that nothing eternal can be built apart from the person and work of the Holy Spirit!